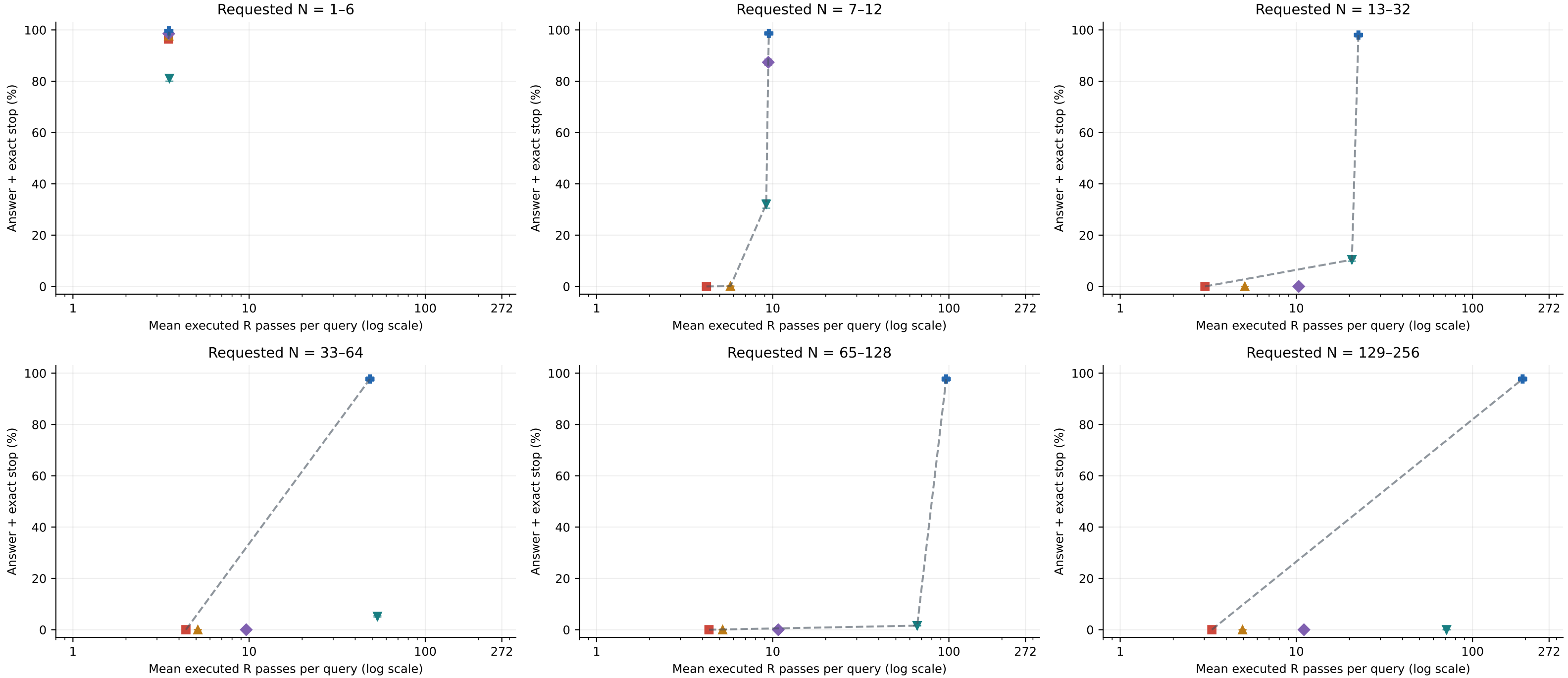
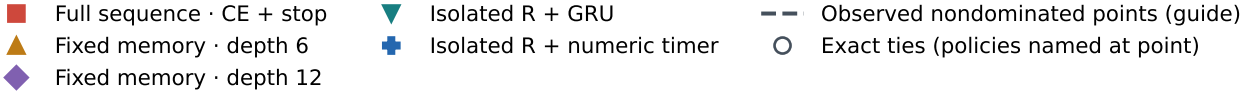


Answer-and-stop quality versus recurrent budget



Frozen policies on the same graphs/counts; 95% paired graph-cluster intervals. Missing stops cost all 272 passes. Loops are a logical budget, not FLOPs/latency; block costs differ. CE-only stopping is undefined and excluded. Exact ties are drawn once with policy names. Frontier is among observed point estimates; no threshold fitting or interpolated policy.